

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Analyst | Microsoft Defender XDR | SIEM | Incident Response | Vulnerability Management

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) with over five years of experience working as a Senior Cyber Security Analyst and Engineer in complex enterprise environments. I bring deep expertise in Tier 2 and Tier 3 security alert triage and incident response, applying independent technical judgement to investigate and contain threats across cloud, on-premise, and third-party estates. I am proficient in Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) platforms, Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) tooling, and the full Microsoft security stack including Microsoft Defender XDR, Defender for Identity, and Microsoft 365 Defender. I have led the full vulnerability management lifecycle from discovery through to remediation tracking, and I have strong experience managing identity-related incidents and account compromise via Microsoft Entra Identity (formerly Azure Active Directory). I combine technical depth with clear communication, enabling me to work effectively with stakeholders across all levels of an organisation.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM and SOAR:** Microsoft Sentinel (Security Information and Event Management), KQL (Kusto Query Language), CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Gen SIEM, Splunk (SPL), SOAR playbook design and automation
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) and XDR:** Microsoft Defender XDR, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), CrowdStrike Falcon EDR/Prevent/Insight/Discover
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus; full exposure management lifecycle across cloud, on-premise, and third-party estates
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Microsoft Entra Identity (Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Microsoft 365 and Cloud Security:** Microsoft 365 (M365) Defender suite, Microsoft Entra, Azure security, Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM), Tanium
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 incident response framework, MITRE ATT&CK framework, structured log data analysis, threat hunting, threat intelligence
- **Security Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK
- **Additional Tools:** Mimecast email security, Check Point Harmony Endpoint, PowerShell scripting

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

March 2025 - Present

- Handle Tier 2 and Tier 3 security alert triage and incident investigations across the Microsoft Defender XDR and Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) tooling, applying independent technical judgement rather than relying solely on predefined playbooks.
- Monitor and respond to threats across Microsoft Entra and Microsoft 365 (M365), including identity-related incidents and account compromise scenarios, integrating alerts from SIEM, EDR, and identity platforms.
- Own the full vulnerability management lifecycle from discovery through to remediation tracking, extending exposure management across cloud, on-premise, and third-party estates using Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), and AppCheck.
- Analyse structured security and log data in Microsoft Sentinel using Kusto Query Language (KQL) to develop high-fidelity detection rules and support proactive threat hunting campaigns.
- Design, build, and maintain Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks to automate alert triage and reduce Mean Time to Respond (MTTR) across the security operations function.
- Lead major incident response investigations under the NIST 800-61 framework, coordinating cross-functional response teams and producing post-incident reports with remediation actions.

- Support hardening, Identity and Access Management (IAM), and architecture work across the Microsoft 365 estate, applying Zero Trust principles and Conditional Access policies to minimise attack surface.
- Apply threat intelligence to improve detection coverage and contribute to third-party security assessments, including vendor risk evaluations and penetration test remediation tracking.
- Manage Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across an estate of over 8,000 users, supporting rollout, configuration, and ongoing tuning.
- Manage BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) platform, enforcing least-privilege controls across administrative accounts and critical infrastructure.

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Monitored and triaged Tier 2 security alerts across SIEM and EDR platforms, escalating confirmed incidents and leading initial containment activities.
- Supported deployment and ongoing management of CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent (Next-Generation Anti-Virus (NGAV)) and Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) modules across the organisation.
- Investigated identity-related incidents and account compromise events in Microsoft Entra (Azure Active Directory), implementing Conditional Access and Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) controls to reduce risk.
- Supported the full vulnerability scanning and remediation cycle using Tenable.io and Nessus, producing management-level reports on risk exposure across the enterprise estate.
- Contributed to MITRE ATT&CK-mapped detection engineering, writing and refining SIEM detection rules and Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) custom indicators of compromise (IOC).
- Supported incident response under NIST 800-61, contributing to containment, eradication, and lessons-learned activities for security incidents affecting the M365 environment.
- Managed Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM) policies, ensuring endpoint compliance and data protection across the device estate.
- Assisted in the organisation's Cyber Essentials Plus certification, reviewing and evidencing controls across network security, patching, access control, and malware protection.

HICX Solutions Ltd (Software as a Service / FinTech)

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Managed endpoint security, network security infrastructure, and cloud security controls across a Software as a Service (SaaS) FinTech environment.
- Supported incident identification and initial triage, monitoring structured security and log data across cloud and on-premise systems.
- Administered Azure Active Directory (now Microsoft Entra Identity) identity and access management, including role-based access control and Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) provisioning.
- Maintained firewall configurations, network monitoring, and patching cycles across the infrastructure estate.
- Supported Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) provisioning for company-owned and Bring Your Own Device (BYOD) endpoints.
- Contributed to security quality reviews and infrastructure compliance checks aligned with ISO 27001 principles.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Deployed and operationalised Microsoft Defender XDR and Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) across an 8,000+ user estate, significantly improving threat visibility and reducing endpoint alert response times.
- Built a structured vulnerability exposure management programme using Tenable.io and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), achieving full-lifecycle tracking from discovery to verified remediation.
- Engineered Microsoft Sentinel Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) detection rules in KQL aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework, increasing high-fidelity alert coverage and reducing false positive rates.
- Designed and deployed Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks that automated alert triage for common identity and endpoint incident types, reducing manual analyst workload.
- Led the organisation's Cyber Essentials Plus certification, coordinating evidence gathering and control remediation across the IT estate.
- Implemented BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) to enforce least-privilege access across critical systems, reducing the attack surface associated with administrative credentials.

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)